Committee: Special Political and Decolonization Committee (SPECPOL)

Topic: The Question of Addressing the Legality of Foreign Intervention in Conflict Zones

Student Officer: Choi Jiwon

Position: Deputy Chair of SPECPOL

Introduction

Foreign intervention in international law commonly refers to the intentional involvement of external nations or organizations to influence the internal affairs of another sovereign state in a militaristic, economic, or political manner. Throughout history, the obscurity of foreign intervention in conflict zones led to being one of the most controversial issues of the international community: Non-military foreign interventions, such as humanitarian aid, are defended by intervening states by being claimed as beneficial to less economically or politically stable states in conflict zones by protecting human rights and contributing to international peace and security. The unstable condition in conflict zones can lead to the deprivation of fundamental human rights of people in those regions, as it is extremely difficult for these nations to solve these problems during a conflict. While this claim is considered truthful on occasion — as seen in the positive outcomes of certain foreign interventions in conflict zones, such as Project INTERFET, which was a UN-authorized operation in East Timor, or the United Kingdom's intervention in Sierra Leone that ended its 11-year civil war — others claim these actions to be against many principles of the international system. One of the most substantial debates regarding foreign intervention in conflict zones is the concern of being misled into a proxy war between global forces, as seen in the examples of Russian Civil War and Spanish Civil War in the early 20th century where the intervention of external forces led to bigger devastation in the state. Opponents of interference in conflict zones also assert that its aftermath can result in long-term unstable political state or ignorance of local context while operating interventions, which is against the state's national sovereignty. On top of that, foreign interventions are often criticized for their selective morality, as states strategically choose which states to intervene in depending on states' self-interest rather than genuine altruism. Although such natures of foreign intervention makes it

questionable among the international society, it is undeniable that some can prevent a wide range of mass atrocity crimes in prior, such as massacre and ethnic cleansing.

To balance national sovereignty against humanitarian duty, the United Nations (UN) has been facilitating clear standards to ensure the recognition of national sovereignty of member states while aiming to prevent the neglect of states in need. The question of intervention within another state has been a fundamental part ever since the foundation of the UN, as seen in Article 2(4), 2(7), and Article 51 of the charter respectively. The General Assembly Resolution 2131 (XX) in 1965 is another display of foreign intervention being discussed in the international community, as it provided a global prohibition on intervention upon another state's internal or external affairs, as well as coercion and subversion. In a more recent era, the 2005 World Summit Document has introduced the concept of Responsibility to Protect (R2P), which aims to prevent mass atrocity crimes in other states to ensure global peace and security.

Despite the UN's previous attempts, the turbulent nature of the conflict zones continues to obscure the boundaries in international frameworks. In conflicts such as armed warfare, it is difficult for the UN to intervene, as many conflicts in the modern era involve non-state actors such as political militias, criminal, and international terrorist groups, classifying them as non-international armed conflicts (NIACs) resulting in restrictions to the UN's influence. The matter of legal consent regarding interventions in conflict zones is another problem dedicated to this topic; in civil wars and other internal conflicts, it is difficult to determine a legitimate governmental authority in the respective state, which complicates the legality of intervention by external forces. Due to its ambiguity, foreign interventions in conflict zones prevail to be one of the most significant international disputes in modern times.

Definition of Key Terms

Intervention

Intervention in international law refers to instances when a state intervenes in the internal affairs of another state, in violation of the latter's sovereignty. Such interference is strictly prohibited under the UN Charter's Article 2(7), widely referred to as the principle of non-intervention, as states accordingly should not intervene in other states' affairs to preserve the sovereignty of more vulnerable states against the interventions and pressures of more powerful ones. Although humanitarian aid activities are excluded from this classification, nations have used humanitarian arguments to justify their armed interventions that infringed on the national sovereignty of one another in the past. Today, the UN Charter explicitly forbids intervention in internal or external affairs of another state; the sole exceptions to this prohibition are in cases of intervention by invitation, intervention authorized by the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), and individual or collective self-defense, as stated in Article 51 of the UN Charter.

Intervention by Invitation

Unlike humanitarian intervention, which is carried out without the host state's permission, intervention by invitation is a term used for military assistance by one or more States to another upon the latter's consent. Its objective is usually to support the requesting state in confrontations with other states or organizations that threaten the nation's security. In inter-state conflicts, the intervention of another state upon consent is considered as a collective self-defense under Article 51 of the UN Charter. While military assistance also includes indirect forms of assistance, such as the supply of war material and military training, other forms of assistance, like financial, technical, or humanitarian aid, are not subject to this term.

Collective Security

Collective Security refers to an international system put in place by the UN Charter in 1945, which is designed to replace the former individual military alliances between states with a more unified and global response system. This system ensures a collective defense of a state by its allies in case of aggression by another state. As the UN Charter prohibits the use of force against another state excluding cases of self-defense, Collective Security consists of a two-step method that prevents

unlawful breakouts of war: During step 1, states are obliged to resolve the conflict through peaceful means such as negotiation, mediation, conciliation, or arbitration. If step 1 fails to work and a state commits an act of aggression, the collective security system escalates to step 2, which enables the Security Council to enforce more forceful measures or even employ international armed forces in severe situations.

International Armed Conflict (IAC)

International Armed Conflicts (IAC) are defined as 'conflicts in which at least two states are involved' in the international law. The IHL claims them as subject to a wide range of rules, such as the Geneva Conventions of 1949 and Additional Protocol I. For a conflict to be an IAC, the parties to the resort must be states or other internationally recognized entities, who are referred to as "High Contracting Parties" formally in the Geneva Conventions 1949. In addition, the use of force needs to be a hostile act, and not a result of a mistake. Once these conditions are met, the IHL comes into action and sets definitions of how the war must be conducted while protecting those who are not or no longer participating in hostilities.

Non-International Armed Conflict (NIAC)

Non-International Armed Conflicts (NIAC) are conflicts that are restricted to the territory of a single state, involving a state and one or more organized armed groups in a situation of violence. Key examples of NIAC include the Syrian Civil War, Colombian conflict against the government and organized guerrilla groups, or the ongoing insurgency in Nigeria. A NIAC must meet two key conditions to be recognized, which are: Meeting a certain level of intensity in terms of violence, and the groups involved being sufficiently organized. If these conditions are both met, a conflict can be identified as a NIAC. Although a NIAC has fewer regulations compared to IAC, the IHL imposes minimal humanitarian standards, such as humanitarian treatment of all persons not or no longer participating in the hostilities, prohibition of murder, torture, and hostage taking, and restrictions on the means and methods of warfare.

International Humanitarian Law (IHL)

The International Humanitarian Law (IHL), also known as the law of war or the law of armed conflict, is a set of rules dedicated to limiting the effects of armed conflict for humanitarian reasons. Being part of the International Law, the IHL was adopted by all 193 member states under the Geneva

Conventions in 1949. It seeks to protect people who are not participating in the hostilities and impose limitations on the methods of warfare. This is only applied for armed conflict, which means it comes into action once a conflict begins and does not come into force for internal tensions or isolated acts of violence. When an intervention occurs, the IHL and the 1949 Geneva Conventions come into effect, as it is instantly classified as an IAC, while also enabling a NIAC to become IAC once there is intervention by foreign state. The IHL determines the legal classification of a conflict once a foreign power intervenes and alters the nature of the hostilities in such interferences.

Responsibility to Protect (R2P)

Being adopted by the UN at the UN World Summit in 2005, Responsibility to Protect (R2P) is an international norm created after the international community failed to respond to the mass atrocities committed in Rwanda and the former Yugoslavia during the 90s. R2P states that individual states have the responsibility to protect its citizens from four mass atrocity crimes, which are stated as genocide, war crimes, ethnic cleansing, and crimes against humanity as stated in the World Summit Outcome Document. Additionally in the document, the international community is responsible for encouraging and assisting other states to achieve this responsibility. R2P also allows the international community to take appropriate collective action through peaceful means in accordance with the UN Charter if a state is failing, or has no will to protect its people,

Delegates must keep in mind that R2P is applied only after a state has explicitly failed to protect its people from the four atrocity crimes (genocide, war crime, crimes against humanity, ethnic cleansing), and the principle of non-intervention will be prioritized over the former.

The Principle of Non-Intervention

Having existed as part of customary international law based on state sovereignty and territorial integrity, the principle of non-intervention involves the right of every sovereign state to conduct its affairs without outside interference. This principle specifies the types of intervention to be not just limited to armed interventions, but also includes paramilitary, financial support, and assistance on opposition groups of the intervened state. The principle of non-intervention has been reflected in numerous declarations adopted by international organizations, such as the General Assembly resolution 2131 (XX) and General Assembly resolution 2625 (XXV), both of which prohibit any form of intervention in internal or external affairs of another state.

Proxy War

A proxy war is an armed conflict where at least one belligerent power is directed or supported by external third-party power, which occurs often in conflict zones as a method of indirect warfare between superpowers. This can lead to prolonged conflict and the loss of autonomy, ultimately inflicting devastating, long-term damage in conflict zones. A notable example of proxy war is the Cold War, which the communist and capitalist forces fought with each other in foreign grounds like Vietnam and Korea; nowadays, the Russia-Ukraine War, Syrian Civil War, and the conflict in Yemen are considered the most prominent ongoing proxy wars.

Background Information

Just War Theory

During medieval times, the doctrine known as Just War theory—first proposed by philosophers such as St. Augustine and Thomas Aquinas—acted as a moral criterion for the justification of how and why wars are fought, being meant to balance between the extremes of realism and pacifism by establishing moral legality regarding warfare. The theory is divided into three branches: *jus ad bellum*, *jus in bello*, and *jus post bellum*.

Jus ad Bellum determines what condition makes going to war become justified, stating self-defense and protection of the innocent as just causes for a war. It mentions war, which is only valid after a legitimate governing body's declaration, as the very last resort after conducting all diplomatic solutions, while having to pursue justice rather than the nation's self-interest or conquest. Ultimately, it demands the positive outcomes of war to outweigh the expected destruction. The next branch, *Jus in bello,* recognizes the ethical standards that govern the conduct in combat, as it highlights the immunity of non-combatants and avoidance of excessive force. *Jus post bellum* refers to the aftermath of war, mentioning avoidance of punishment upon innocents and respecting the rights or traditions of the defeated.

Despite being focused on conventional inter-state warfare rather than intervention itself, this theory has been a rudimental basis of warfare ethics and applied in various wars throughout history for their justification. International agreements such as the Geneva Convention 1949 and Hague Convention demonstrate Just War theory's influence at limiting unethical warfare. Even as of now, Just War theory remains relevant as a moral framework in deciding the legality of modern foreign interventions and later becoming the background inspiration for the UN's R2P. Being the major principle of modern international law, this theory proposes clear ethical standards when solving contemporary problems related to intervention for all states.

UN's Efforts after World War II

Throughout World War II, various types of foreign intervention occurred worldwide, as many nations shifted their stance to engage economically, militarily, and diplomatically in global affairs. Such warfare led to a great number of casualties and the creation of conflict zones worldwide, leaving

unstable consequences. These factors propelled the United Nations to come into existence in 1945 after the war's demise.

In the same year, the UN Charter was adopted by 51 states across the globe, which now act as the principle of international law. Two of the most important articles related to intervention under the UN Charter are Article 2(4) and Article 2(7), as the former defines the prohibition of threat or use of force against another state and the latter prohibits intervention in matters which are essentially within the domestic jurisdiction of any state, affirming the principle of non-intervention under international law. On the other hand, Chapter VII of the Charter specifies itself as an exception to the principle of non-intervention and allows intervention to maintain or restore international peace and security, which disregards the previous Articles in times of 'threat to peace.' Article 51 acknowledges the inherent right of individual or collective self-defense if an armed attack occurs against a member state, allowing military response until the UNSC has taken necessary measures, while such actions must be reported immediately to the UNSC. The four 1949 Geneva Conventions add up to the global regulations regarding armed conflicts as a direct response to the inhumanities from World War II. Despite not directly addressing the issue of intervention, these treaties address the legality of different types of warfare and the protection of innocents, forming the foundation of the International Humanitarian Law (IHL).

In a more recent era, the UN has created several frameworks and resolutions to address the definitions and boundaries of foreign intervention. Most notable resolution is the General Assembly Resolution 2131 (XX) in 1965, which was adopted during the cold war era to prohibit direct or indirect intervention in affairs of any state while respecting states' self-determination, and General Assembly Resolution 2625 (XXV) in 1970, which emphasized the principle of non-intervention and discouragement of use of force against another state. These resolutions assisted the consolidation of state sovereignty and self-determination, remaining a crucial part of international law as of now.

Classifications of Interventions

Interventions under international law are generally categorized into two primary types: Direct intervention and indirect intervention. Direct interventions refer to military intervention or intervention by forcible or dictatorial means, which include the military occupation of territory, embargo, demonstration, blockade, asset seizure, and other similar measures done in a forceful manner; these actions are all prohibited under the UN Charter. On the contrary, indirect intervention usually refers to three types of intervention: The first is subversive intervention, which is any activity

by one state to affect the situation in another state. Next is economic intervention or coercion, which involves the imposition of sanctions, embargoes, and boycotts by interfering with trade and shipping; another form of this intervention includes banning export and import or external economic policy impositions by International Financial Institutions (IFI) while taking action under Article 41 of the UN Charter. It is hard to define legitimate economic sanctions and illegal pressure put upon another state, making economic intervention highly debatable. Lastly, diplomatic interventions against another state are usually declared as unfriendly acts rather than illegal interventions, but they can be considered one when involving communications of threatening tone, use of military or other coercive measures.

Under the UN Charter, only two entities—UN and a state—are permitted to intervene, and other entities such as private persons, institutions, or corporations can violate the principle of non-intervention through their behavior. Collective intervention is a type of UN-led intervention that is generally accepted as the exception to the principle of non-intervention under Article 2(7), being authorized by the UNSC when it determines a threat to international peace, a breach of peace, or any act of aggression. The range of collective intervention can vary from humanitarian interventions to civil wars and environment catastrophes, such as the civil wars in Libya, Congo, and Iraq by UNSC. On the other hand, unilateral interventions are types of intervention conducted by individual sovereign states, and in most cases, they are strictly prohibited under the UN Charter, hence being called as "unauthorized intervention" in some occasions. Unilateral intervention on humanitarian ground sparks significant debate upon the international society due to the lack of international authority, as well as destroying local stability and risk of abusing "humanitarian grounds" as an excuse of ill-willed interference.

Main Category	Type	Subcategories
By method	Direct intervention	Military intervention, intervention by forcible or dictatorial means
	Indirect intervention	subversive, economic, diplomatic intervention
By authority	Collective intervention	humanitarian, civil wars & internal conflicts, environmental catastrophe, peace management
	Unilateral intervention	humanitarian, self-defense, punitive
By legal exception	Intervention by Invitation	military, political (provided upon the host government's explicit consent)

Interventions throughout History

Before the UN came into action, major military interventions have occurred frequently in various conflicts, which included the multilateral intervention upon civil wars. The Russian Civil War is a prominent example of military intervention history, prevailing from 1917 to 1922, when its newly established government's alliance with Germany propelled the Allied forces to conduct intervention that escalated into an attempt to prevent communist ideology. The Spanish Civil War was originally an internal conflict between left and right, but it quickly deteriorated into an international proxy war between fascism and communism. This devastating war led to the death of over 500,000 people, and Spain's economy and infrastructure were left in ruins as the consequences of foreign intervention.

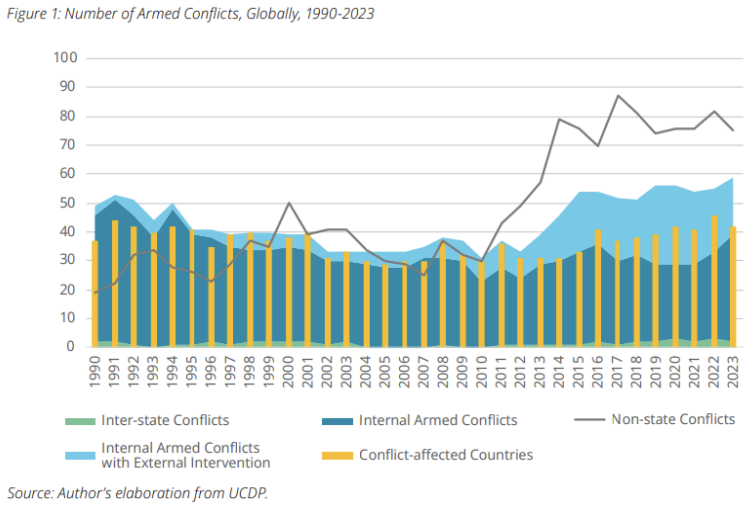
Despite establishing the principle of non-intervention in the UN Charter after the UN's creation, the amount of foreign involvement and military interventions did not decrease in number. During the cold war period, proxy warfare between capitalism and communism occurred frequently worldwide, as seen in the examples of the Korean War, Vietnam War, and Soviet-Afghan War. After the Cold War, nations continued to directly interfere in conflict zones, and some were conducted legally with the UNSC's permission: This includes the multilateral intervention in the Gulf War in 1991, when the US-led coalition drove off Iraqi forces from Kuwait after Iraqi dictator Saddam Hussein's invasion of the country. The UN Operation on Somalia (UNOSOM) from 1992 to 1995 was another collective intervention as a global effort to stop mass starvation and civil war in Somalia, but the withdrawal of Western troops resulted in the lack of political reconciliation or a stable central government. Some interventions were conducted without any UNSC authorization, a famous example being the US's military intervention in Iraq back in 2003; This intervention is generally classified as unauthorized intervention without UN consent in international law, as the former UN secretary-general Kofi Annan has also confirmed it to be 'illegal.'

Nations did not only participate in military interventions, but also were conducting indirect interventions against states. Notable examples of this action include the international economic sanctions against Iraq in 1991 and the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK) in 2016, where all member states were prevented from providing assistance in weapons of mass destruction (WMD)-related matters to weaken the target regimes without direct military engagement.

One of the most prominent events regarding both direct and indirect intervention in internal conflicts was the International Court of Justice's (ICJ) case between the United States of America and Nicaragua in 1986, when the latter filed an application against the United States in violation of the UN

Charter and customary international law; Although the United States claimed its intentions to be of "collective self-defense" for neighboring nations, this statement was refuted by multiple evidences of military and paramilitary activities conducted in Nicaragua territory, most significantly the financial and militaristic support given to the anti-government rebels in Nicaragua. The ICJ's verdict was that the US breached the principle of non-intervention due to the inappropriate use of force. Even though the United States refused to comply with the verdict, this incident had left a significant influence in regards to the legality of foreign intervention, as it redefined the border between humanitarian intervention and military invasion.

Non-state Actors in Conflict Zones



Number of armed conflicts globally, from 1990 to 2023 (United Nations Interregional Crime and Justice Research Institute (UNICRI), 2025)

In modern days, non-international armed conflicts (NIACs) take up a significant portion of conflicts more than traditional inter-state wars. The proliferation of non-state armed groups (NSAGs), which include both non-state actors and terrorist groups designated by the UNSC, over the past decade has been a crucial factor of the growing number, as conflicts involving NSAGs have increased together during the same period according to the Uppsala Conflict Data Program. This motion is especially prevalent in Africa, Middle East, and Latin America, witnessing the highest number of armed conflicts since the Second World War.

Non-state actors and foreign interventions are closely connected, as the former gives an opportunity for justifying interventions in conflict zones. NIACs, especially foreign

intervention-fueled ones, are exceptionally harder for the UN to stop compared to conventional inter-state wars, creating a legal loophole that paralyzes UN intervention under the name of state sovereignty and non-interference. States can indirectly intervene in the NIAC as a form of proxy warfare by supporting non-state actors, which can deteriorate the ongoing conflict and lead to prolonged devastation in the region. The difficulty of confirming peace agreements between entities and obscure accountability of non-state actors also act as a major challenge for the UN regarding non-state actors in conflict zones with foreign assistance. States tend to avoid state responsibility when supporting non-state actors by indirectly assisting through methods like generalized funding or providing weapons and strategic intelligence, which bypasses the responsibility by not issuing the direct commands for non-state actors.

Deliberate Non-intervention

Before the notion of R2P came into existence, there have been several incidents which the international society did not intervene in the 90s that led to its creation: One of them was Rwandan genocide, where the extremist factions of Rwanda's majority Hutu population committed a planned mass murder on the minority Tutsi population and moderate Hutus from April to July 1994. This led to the death of over 800,000 civilians and the fleeing of approximately 2,000,000 Rwandans throughout the course of genocide. Another notable example that encouraged the adoption of pro-intervention ideas is the conflict in Bosnia, where over 100,000 people were killed during the conflict. During the conflict, the genocide against Bosnian Muslim population by Bosnian Serbian forces in Srebrenica led to over 8,000 casualties, plus the forced migration of about 20,000 people.

The international community failed to intervene in the mass massacres mentioned above, as major global powers decided they had no strategic value. Especially for Rwanda's case, governments actively avoided using the term "genocide," as that would have obliged nations to intervene, thus establishing deliberate policies of non-intervention. The UN's reliance on member states regarding the supported troops and resources, as well as deployed peacekeepers' neutral stance on both agenda that hindered them from intervening in the genocides, were another factor that propelled nations to be hesitant on sending assistance.

State Responsibility in International Law

In international law, state responsibility acts as a pivotal foundation for regulating and penalizing unauthorized foreign interventions. It is governed primarily by customary international law

and officially codified in the UN's Articles on Responsibility of States for Internationally Wrongful Acts (ARSIWA), which manages the legality of foreign interventions via its content. Despite not being a treaty, the Articles remain the most influential statement of the international law regarding its secondary rules, meaning it is what is followed after a state fails to comply with an international obligation.

State responsibility provides a clearer definition regarding the involvement of states and their attributions in interventions, including indirect methods which its responsibilities are hard to define. Article 2 of the International Law Commission Report 2001 defines intentionally wrongful acts of a state by specifying them as being attributable to the state under international law and constituting a breach of an international obligation of the state. Other articles of the report, such as Article 4, 5, and 6, attribute a wide range of conducts, including non-state actor conducts, to states if acting under state direction, asserting state responsibility in such actions. This includes the conduct of any state organ, entities empowered by the law of the state to exercise elements of the governmental authority, organization placed at the disposal of a state by another state (which its responsibility goes to the former), and individuals or groups acting under the instructions of the state. The last, which is mentioned in Article 8, causes the state to have state responsibility for non-state actors when their actions are state-instructed.

State responsibility is unauthorized for the criminal punishment of the state, but its function is mainly corrective and relational. It acts as a restoration for legal injury and compliance as far as possible, and is generally objective, as it leans more toward questioning whether a state conformed its binding international obligations or not instead of its subjective intention.

Humanitarian Intervention and R2P

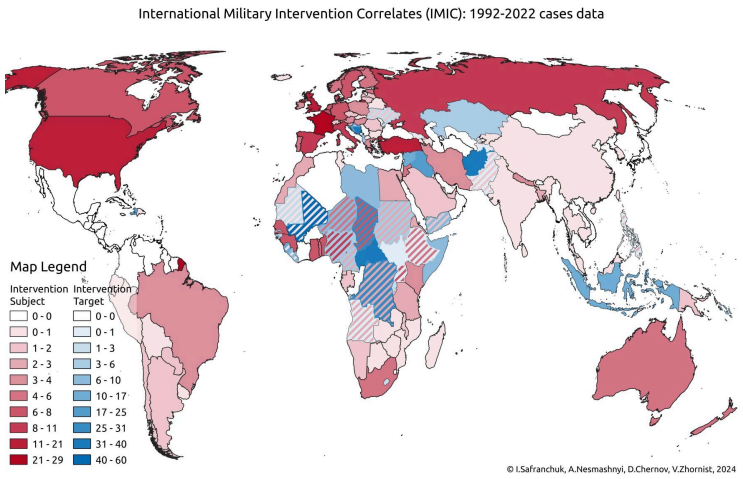
Humanitarian intervention, both occurring collectively and unilaterally, remains a highly debated issue due to the growing impact of human rights law in international law. While the UN is systemically unable to intervene in the affairs of any member states, the provisions of Chapter VII are applicable once the national authorities are unwilling or unable to protect their populations, provided the situation threatens international peace and security.

However, this type of intervention becomes deeply controversial when undertaken unilaterally, as the term can be abused to justify interventions against international law; Many supporters, such as jurist Fernando Teson, believe the development of international humanitarian law

provides legal validity to it, and it is morally justified in appropriate cases. On the other hand, critics argue that humanitarian intervention is contradictory to the provisions of the UN Charter, not to mention it is prone to misuse by states for the sake of protecting human rights. 133 states of the Group of 77 (G-77) and China had rejected the legality of unilateral humanitarian intervention back in the First South Summit of the G-77 in 2000. This rejection was a direct response to NATO's 1999 intervention in Kosovo, which had bypassed the UNSC due to a threatened Russian veto. While supporters viewed NATO's actions as morally imperative to stop ethnic cleansing, critics condemned it as a dangerous violation of state sovereignty that brought up the involvement of a new framework.

To resolve this legal obstacle, R2P came to action in 2005 as an international norm designed to protect populations from the neglect of the international community while reinforcing the principles of the UN Charter and international law. This framework consists of three prominent pillars: State responsibility to protect its own population, the international community's duty to assist states in doing so, and making timely and decisive responses via UNSC in case of failure to protect human rights in other states. The last allows collective intervention by the international community when a state fails to protect its citizens or has no willingness to protect them, although it is only used as a last resort with the UNSC's strict oversight.

Current Conflicts involving External Powers



The Time of Interventions: From Practice to Data (Russia in Global Affairs, 2024)

According to ICRC's "Humanitarian Outlook 2026," there are more than 100 ongoing conflicts across the world as of now, as it reached 130 back in 2024. Conflicts now tend to be less of

inter-state scale, but rather waged between domestic groups; due to this, the target of interventions are mainly focused on conflict zones located in northern and central Africa and the Middle East, while the United States of America have been widely recognized as the top nation to intervene in most affairs of other nations.

The Syrian Civil War is an infamous ongoing conflict with foreign interventions; being one of the biggest ongoing conflicts in the modern era, Syria's once domestic affair has been transformed into a complex theater of multi-state military involvement over the fifteen years. By 2024, approximately 801 foreign military bases were active across the nation, as foreign powers established various military bases and deployed troops to secure their strategic advantages. As of December 2024, the balance of power between participants has dramatically shifted due to the capture of key cities by Islamist rebels, marking the most substantial change in territorial control since 2020. As the recently deposed authority, the Assad regime, is actively trying to reclaim these regions, it is unclear whether there will be more interventions—from nations such as the US—or not.

Since the commencement of the Russia-Ukraine War, international interventions have been an inseparable part of the war, seen from the provision of direct military, financial, and material support for Ukraine from Western allies alongside military and economic backing for Russia from nations such as Iran, North Korea, and Belarus. Pro-Ukrainian forces have also been enforcing wide-ranging economic sanctions on Russia.

The situation in Gaza and the rest of the Middle East is also in crucial condition like the conflicts above. In Gaza, the US is in military and intelligence support for Israel while negotiating for a ceasefire while the EU has openly declared for sustained distribution of humanitarian assistance throughout Gaza to save lives and reduce suffering. The Israeli invasion in Lebanon has also led to Iran's assistance of Hezbollah against US-backed Israel, alongside the conflict regarding Strait of Hormuz and the Bab el-Mandeb strait where Iran and its allied proxy forces implemented blockade to the US, Israel, and Saudi Arabia. Other internationalized civil wars in the Middle East include the Saudi-led intervention in the Yemeni civil war.

Possible solutions

On the legal framework of non-intervention in conflict zones, delegates must consider the different perspectives regarding intervention across member states and the balance between maintaining national sovereignty and preserving humanitarian rights. The unstable condition of conflict zones is to be considered to prevent the outbreak of proxy wars and assist its restoration after the intervention. Other key themes to discuss within the committee are settling clear boundaries of R2P and humanitarian intervention's influence; in conflict zones, it is hard to define which bodies are legally authorized to permit intervention by invitation, which can only be authorized by a legitimate governmental body of the state. The principles mentioned in existing documents can be reaffirmed and modified to set visible boundaries of legitimacy regarding foreign intervention.

Restricting State-sponsored Proxy Warfare

Indirect intervention in conflict zones are usually conducted as a method of proxy warfare between politically stronger states; sponsoring states engage in active conflicts through financial support, weapons, or logistical aid, or intelligence sharing to armed groups within the conflict, leading to more destruction and harm in conflict zones. As proxy warfare is not explicitly prohibited by any international legal framework, it is crucial to establish a definitive framework for the restriction of proxy warfare in conflict zones based on the content of IHL and Article 2(4) of the UN Charter. This includes enhancing transparency regarding intervention in armed conflict zones to ensure that the intervention is not done for the stir of proxy warfare.

Defining the Boundaries of Foreign Intervention in NIAC

Intervening in an IAC is highly risky for foreign powers, as it is illegal to do so without UNSC's permission under the international law; thus, many nations prefer to make indirect interventions in a NIAC for both humanitarian or self-interest purposes. This provides the intervening states with the opportunity to legally justify their actions via 'Intervention by Invitation' from authoritative bodies of the nation, avoid escalation of a bigger inter-state conflict, and save resources by deploying support in a smaller scale, like financial aid instead of a full-fledged conventional military deployment. However, there are many cases of nations supporting third-party armed groups or terrorist groups via the name of Intervention by Invitation, which is against the original idea and furthermore disrupts global peace. To prevent the abuse of NIAC interventions, the international

community should discuss the definition of legitimate authority that allows intervention by invitation, as well as the legality of external powers intervening on behalf of non-state or opposition groups in NIACs.

Fortifying Monitoring and Accountability Mechanisms for R2P

Although R2P is a critical measure to ensure peace and security within the international community, Pillar III under the R2P, which enables military intervention when a state manifestly fails to protect its populations, remains controversial due to concerns regarding its potential misuse by foreign states. A distinct criteria for the verification of mass atrocity allegations before conducting military intervention is necessary to prevent unjust R2P applications in the first place, alongside strict frameworks that draw the line between non-lethal humanitarian assistance and violation of sovereignty.

Strengthening the Role of Regional Organizations

Regional organizations, such as the African Union (AU), Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS), and Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) under Chapter VII of the UN Charter are often first responders in regional crises, yet they cannot conduct enforcement action before the UNSC's authorization in most cases. This leads to the need for addressing the legal balance between quick responses of regional organizations and UNSC's authorization. As regional organizations can prevent intervention of broader external powers, different ways to utilize regional organizations in diplomatic mediations and de-escalation of conflicts can be found via cooperation with neighboring nations.

Collective Response to Unilateral Military Intervention

Unilateral intervention not only undermines a nation's sovereignty, but it is also considered a violation of the UN Charter, as it is unauthorized by the UNSC and done in a unilateral manner. This matter is especially prevalent when the state conducting the unilateral intervention is part of the Permanent 5 (P5), as they possess the authority to exercise their veto power that allows them to cancel out decisions from the UNSC. This allows the P5 nations to veto any substantive UNSC resolutions that condemn the said state's intervention, overriding the democratic consensus of the wider global community. To deter nations from committing unauthorized interventions, delegates should look for different methods of multilateral response within the UN framework, such as utilizing the General

Assembly or regional partnership when they are unable to condemn such actions in conventional manner.

Providing Reparations for Post-Intervention States

Whether conducted by economic blockades, cyber operations, political manipulation, or military force, foreign interventions can result in severe structural, financial, or institutional damage to the intervened state. Despite legal international measures to repair the harm caused by such actions, it takes a long time to fully restore the damaged national stability, such as its infrastructure, economy, or political environment, in host states in conflict zones. Thus, delegates should analyze the application of international frameworks regarding compensation and non-repetition of foreign intervention as part of state responsibility. To guarantee the reparations for host states regardless of foreign intervention's type, mechanisms for post-conflict accountability and asset recovery can be established in order to calculate the size of compensation.

Major Parties Involved

North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)

NATO's operations in the Euro-Atlantic region and beyond are driven by motives of stopping humanitarian crises and regional instability, ranging from peace support operations following conflicts to humanitarian interventions. Its interventions are usually carried out with the host nation's explicit consent, international agreements, or an UNSC mandate; the NATO Mission Iraq (NMI) and missions in Afghanistan and North Macedonia were conducted under the host nation's request, and the ongoing NATO's Kosovo Force (KFOR) established as a UN-mandated peace support. NATO also maintains practical cooperation with the African Union (AU) to tackle shared security threats and challenges.

United States of America

Being the most influential intervener in history, the US has been intervening in foreign military, economic, and covert interventions, engaging in nearly 500 conflicts all across the world. These interventions were driven by regional dominance, anti-communism, economic interests, and counter-terrorism. During the cold war era, most US interventions were conducted to stop the distribution of communist propaganda, like its contribution to the Korean War or the Vietnam War. The US has also operated humanitarian interventions in Somalia, Haiti, and the Balkans for peacekeeping and half ethnic cleansing. Following the 9/11 attack, the US committed large-scale invasions in Afghanistan and Iraq framed around counter-terrorism and eliminating weapons of mass destruction. Recently, the US has committed a massive regime change in Venezuela back in January 2026 alongside the US-Israeli joint military intervention known as Project Epic Fury against Iran.

Islamic Republic of Iran

Iran is in a unique position as a conflict zone in current global relations, where it is both facing heavy interference by outer states while operating active military and political interventions itself. Iran has funded armed regional military networks, such as Hezbollah—the Lebanese armed group backed by Iran—and military groups in Iraq and Syria to project regional influence and counter US and Israeli actions. Following the events of September 11, Iran had been labelled as part of an "axis of evil" by the US, succeeded by restrictions of its nuclear activities and the restoration of past sanctions. In February 2026, US-Israeli attacks were conducted in Iran for the purpose of regime

change, which killed thousands of people in Iran while the supreme leader was replaced by other religious leaders, ultimately intensifying the conflict.

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

Saudi Arabia has a notable history of diverse regional intervention, the most famous example being the multilateral military coalition in the Yemeni Civil War in 2015 while also frequently intervening in domestic and regional politics to oppose external influence. Recently, the Kingdom has shifted its view on interventions to leaning towards deterrence through regional alliances and targeted defensive measures over militaristic actions against another state. Saudi Arabia has also vocally condemned external involvement in sovereign states such as the situation in Yemen and Sudan.

People's Republic of China

China's foreign policy has been centered around a public stance of non-interference of other sovereign states, but it has proven to be impractical due to its recurrent engagement in foreign matters. Being different from conventional Western military interventions, China's modern strategy regarding intervention focuses on the avoidance of direct combat and rather the utilization of diplomatic mediation and expansion of its influence. China has also used plausible deniability as a tool to provide friendly regimes with dual-use technology, satellite imagery, and such without triggering direct military confrontation with external powers.

Republic of Yemen

Due to the unstable condition caused by fractured domestic factions, Yemen is widely recognized as a global theater for conducting foreign interventions. The internal actors of Yemen actively invite, resist, or project foreign intervention differently to achieve their own political goals. The Presidential Leadership Council (PLC) is the globally recognized government of Yemen, relying heavily on Saudi Arabia's assistance while opposing uncoordinated foreign interventions. Meanwhile, the Houthi Movement, or Ansar Allah, strongly opposes Western and Saudi interference in Yemen, instead maintaining decades of ideological and military relationship with Iran while relying heavily on its advanced drone and missile technology. The Southern Transitional Council (STC) represents the southern secessionist movement, being in favor of the UAE and resisting Saudi-led alignment.

Russian Federation

Over the post-Soviet era, Russia's stance changed from pro-western integration to the enforcement of a multipolar world order involving itself over global security architecture. Due to this, Russian interventions are driven by the desire to avoid geopolitical loss, maintaining unresolved conflicts to limit these governments' sovereignty and territorial control, and supporting allied regimes. This is conducted to prevent neighboring nations from falling into Western hands and joining Western institutions such as the EU or NATO, as seen in the current military leverages in regions like Georgia. Russia has been supporting its allied regime in Syria for its civil war while receiving indirect foreign support from allied nations like Iran, North Korea, and China.

Syrian Arab Republic

Following the uprising of the infamous multi-sided conflict in 2011, major global and regional powers intervened directly or via proxies in Syria to secure their own interests. Before the civil war, interventions in Syria were primarily diplomatic or strategic rather than direct military combat. Before the fall of the Assad regime in late 2024, pro-Assad forces such as Russia, Hezbollah, and Iran supported their allied government by providing military support. On the other side, anti-Assad forces such as Turkiye, Gulf nations, the US and Western countries supported Syrian rebel forces or took direct military actions. Since the Assad Regime's extraction, the international community is moving rapidly to engage with the new leadership, despite al-Sharaa's past extremist affiliations, while leading to the collapse of the pro-Assad axis of Russia, Hezbollah, and Iran.

Timeline Of Events

Date	Description of Event
UN Charter is adopted, October 1945	The UN Charter is adopted, which includes the concept of principle of non-intervention
ICJ's Military and Paramilitary Activities in and against Nicaragua judgement, 1986	Nicaragua files an application on the US for militaristically assisting anti-government forces
The UN Operation on Somalia (UNOSOM), 1992–1995	Failed attempt to stop mass starvation and civil war in somali due to western withdrawal
Genocide in Rwanda, April–July 1994	The Hutu extremist government commits mass genocide on the Tutsi
Srebrenica Massacre, July 1995	Bosnian Serb forces commit organized murder on Bosnian Muslims in Srebrenica, Yugoslavia
NATO's intervention in Kosovo, March–June 1999	NATO conducts aerial bombing campaign against Yugoslavia to prevent humanitarian catastrophes
US's military intervention in Iraq, 2003	unauthorized intervention to topple Saddam Hussein's regime and eliminate alleged WMD
2005 World Summit, 2005	The concept of R2P is officially recognized
Syrian Civil War, 2011–	Following the Arab Spring, the Assad regime's response to protestors led to conflict between the government and its opposing factions

UN Involvement, Resolutions, Treaties and Events

- General Assembly Resolution 2131 (XX), 21 DEC 1965 (A/RES/20/2131)

Also known as the Declaration on the Inadmissibility of Intervention in the Domestic Affairs of States and the Protection of Their Independence and Sovereignty, this resolution was adopted amidst the Cold War and the decolonization era, as dozens of newly decolonized

states did not want to get winded up in US and Soviet's affairs. The resolution prohibits direct or indirect intervention in affairs of any state, alongside any kind of economic or political coercion and the overthrow of another government. It also respects every state's right of self-determination and independence, affirming their freedom from any foreign pressure while upholding human rights and opposing colonialism. As of today, this resolution holds significance regarding non-intervention and self-determination of states, being cited in notable legal cases and events.

- General Assembly Resolution 2625 (XXV), 24 OCT 1970 (A/RES/2625)

Also known as the Declaration on Principles of International Law concerning Friendly Relations and Cooperation among States in accordance with the Charter of the United Nations, this resolution highlights the principle of non-intervention and cooperation for states against each other. It also mentions states must refrain from the threat or use of force against the territorial integrity or political independence of any state, and recommends settling international disputes through peaceful means so that international peace and security, as well as nations' sovereign equality, are not endangered. Although resolutions of the GA are technically non-binding, the resolution is widely recognized as a formal elaboration of customary international law regarding state conduct, as many of its principles reflect the respective rules.

- Declaration on the Inadmissibility of Intervention and Interference in the Internal Affairs of States, 9 DEC 1981 (A/RES/36/103)

This resolution addresses the loopholes of Resolution 2131 by further specifying explicit protections against broader forms of interference. It reaffirms the core statement in 2131, stating that states cannot intervene in another state's internal or external affairs. However, the resolution specifies the extent of economic coercion, and introduces the duty to refrain from distributing mass media or broadcasting hostile reports for the purpose of spreading state-sponsored propaganda. While Resolution 2131 focuses on the elimination of colonialism, the Declaration further mandates that no state may use human rights issues as a political pretext to undermine the sovereignty of a state.

- Declaration on the Enhancement of the Effectiveness of the Principle of Refraining from the Threat or Use of Force in International Relations, 18 NOV 1987 (A/RES/42/22)

This document focuses on the aspects of Article 2(4) of the UN Charter, as it declares the absolute ban on the threat or use of force against another state. This is applied for all states regardless of their political, economic, social, or military system, stating no internal justification can exclude the threat or use of force from this prohibition. It also forbids any indirect force, which includes paramilitary, terrorist, or subversive acts in another state, alongside territorial acquisition or special advantage resulting from the threat or use of force. This resolution clearly defines the threat or use of force, and mandates states to settle peaceful means to resolve disputes, ultimately strengthening the UN's role in solving international conflicts via the UNSC and ICJ.

- 2005 World Summit Outcome Document, 24 OCT 2005 (A/RES/60/1)

Paragraphs 138~140 of the World Summit Outcome Document affirms sovereign states' responsibility to protect populations from genocide, war crimes, ethnic cleansing and crimes against humanity, also known as R2P. The document extends the boundary of this responsibility by stating the international community should encourage and help States to exercise this responsibility, as well as taking collective action in a timely and decisive manner through the security council when a state fails to do so. Unlike traditional humanitarian intervention in prior resolutions, the method of collective action can include the use of military force, though it must be acted as the very last resort and explicitly authorized by the SC under Chapter VII of the UN Charter.

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